

Whiskey.Investments

Business model & landing page blueprint

Prepared for John Parnell · 11 June 2026

The model in one line. You run a digital reservation storefront for Great Northern Distillery whiskey casks. Investors size their order with a calculator and pay a **non-refundable 10% deposit that is yours to keep as commission**. The moment that deposit clears, the order and the investor's details pass straight to GND, who collect the 90% balance and make, store, certify and resell the cask. You never touch the balance, never hold stock, and never make a sales call.

1. How the money flows

The 10% reservation deposit is your margin; everything downstream is the distillery's responsibility. Because the casks are made to order, the deposit is non-refundable — stated plainly in your terms and conditions and acknowledged at checkout.

Stage	What happens	Who holds the money
1. Reserve	Investor uses the calculator to size their order, then completes checkout: all required details and passport are collected first, and only then is the non-refundable 10% deposit taken.	You (your commission)
2. Handover	Once the deposit lands and is matched to its order reference, the full order pack and KYC are sent to Great Northern Distillery automatically.	—
3. Balance	GND invoices and collects the remaining 90% directly from the investor, then makes the cask to order, stores it, and issues the ownership certificate.	Great Northern
4. Aftercare	Storage, insurance, dashboard, documentation, resale and buy-back all sit with GND. You are not in the loop.	Great Northern

Why this is the cleanest version: you are an introducer, not a money-handler. GND collects the 90% balance directly, so you never hold investor funds beyond your own commission — which sharply reduces your financial-services and client-money exposure.

2. The one thing you must lock down first

The entire “hands-off” promise rests on a written Introducer / Commission Agreement with Great Northern Distillery (or their cask-sales partner) confirming:

- **Commission ownership** — the non-refundable 10% reservation deposit is your retained commission and is not owed onward;

- **Balance collection** — GND invoices and collects the remaining 90% directly from each investor;
- **Fulfilment ownership** — GND owns make-to-order production, allocation, storage, insurance, certificates, the dashboard, resale and buy-back;
- **Data & KYC** — GND accepts the order pack and full KYC you collect at checkout, and confirms who is data controller for it.

GND already publishes a “Prestige Cask Sales” programme, so a cask-introducer arrangement is squarely within what they do — but it must be in writing before you advertise.

3. Pricing & your unit economics

Casks are £2,000 each. They are bought by the crate — one crate is 6 casks (£12,000) — and orders rise in whole crates, with a one-crate minimum. Your commission is always 10% of the order value.

Volume discount — the more crates, the bigger the discount

Recommended method: a tiered crate discount. A single flat percentage is applied to the whole order, set by the number of crates ordered. It is easy to understand, trivial to render live in the calculator, and visibly rewards larger commitments. (An alternative — marginal discounting, where only the crates above each threshold are discounted — is fairer at the margin but harder for a first-time buyer to follow, so flat banding is the better front-end choice.)

Crates	Casks	Discount on order	Price / cask	Tier name
1	6	—	£2,000	Starter
2 – 4	12 – 24	2.5%	£1,950	Builder
5 – 9	30 – 54	5%	£1,900	Investor
10 – 19	60 – 114	7.5%	£1,850	Premium
20 – 49	120 – 294	10%	£1,800	Portfolio
50 +	300 +	12.5%	£1,750	Founder

What you earn per order

Your 10% scales with the discounted order value. A bigger order discounts the per-cask price but still pays you far more in absolute commission.

Crates	Casks	Price / cask	Order value	Your 10% deposit
1	6	£2,000	£12,000	£1,200
2	12	£1,950	£23,400	£2,340
5	30	£1,900	£57,000	£5,700
10	60	£1,850	£111,000	£11,100
20	120	£1,800	£216,000	£21,600
50	300	£1,750	£525,000	£52,500

Your only running costs: payment processing on the deposit, the website and hosting, a KYC tool, the bank/automation connectors, and ad spend. Everything else is margin.

Note on the discount and your margin: because the discount reduces the whole order value, it also trims your 10% slightly. Agree with GND whether the discount comes out of their 90%, is shared, or your 10% sits on top of the discounted price — so the tiers above stay profitable for you.

4. The landing page

Proposition

Lead with the **fintech “future of whiskey investing”** angle — it should feel like Stripe or Revolut, not a whiskey merchant. Headline: *“The future of whiskey investing.”* Subline: invest directly into distillery-backed Irish whiskey casks through the world’s first dedicated whiskey investment platform — transparent pricing, verifiable ownership, complete investor control.

Funnel: calculator, then reserve

The visitor journey educates first and asks second. The calculator does the persuading; the reservation does the converting. One page, anchor navigation, mobile-first.

#	Section	Job it does
1	Hero	“The future of whiskey investing.” Fintech framing, one bold headline, trust badges, primary CTA Reserve casks plus secondary Download guide.
2	Why we exist	Names the market problem (inflated prices, hidden fees, cold-callers, unclear ownership) then positions you as the transparent alternative.
3	Why whiskey	Finite supply, growing global demand, tangible asset, recession-resilient. Modern stat cards — every claim disclaimer-safe.
4	How it works (6 steps)	Choose amount → reserve → verify → documentation → track → sell. Removes first-timer anxiety before the calculator.
5	Cask calculator	The centre of gravity. Crate slider (minimum 1 crate / 6 casks, rising in crates of 6) updating live: order value, tier discount, saving, 10% deposit, estimated future value. Ends in Reserve my allocation.
6	Featured investment	One product — the GND AB2 Irish Malt Cask — not a catalogue. Simplicity builds confidence and keeps fulfilment uniform.
7	Great Northern Distillery	Trust transfer: Ireland’s largest independent distillery, ex-Cooley/Kilbeggan founders, 500k casks in bond. Their credibility becomes yours.
8	Trust & proof	Verifiable ownership, 5-year insured storage, buy-back support, Trustpilot/testimonials, and the mandatory ASA/CAP risk disclaimers.
9	FAQ + final CTA	Accordion answering ownership, storage, resale, risk, tax. Closes on Reserve casks with the non-refundable deposit explained plainly.

Primary CTA everywhere: Reserve casks (pay the 10% deposit). **Secondary CTA:** Download the investment guide (captures the email of anyone not ready to reserve yet).

5. Automation — watching deposits land without lifting a finger

Your only recurring job is confirming that deposits arrive and forwarding paid orders to GND. That can be fully automated with a bank connector and a daily scheduled task:

1. **Capture** — Checkout collects every required detail plus the passport, assigns a unique order reference, and takes the non-refundable 10% deposit. The investor pays using that reference.
2. **Read the bank** — A daily scheduled task queries your bank/payment connector for new incoming transactions and reads each payment reference.
3. **Match** — Each reference is matched to its open order in your records to confirm the deposit has cleared.
4. **Notify GND** — For every newly-paid order, the task automatically sends GND the full order pack and KYC, then marks the order “handed over” so it is never sent twice.
5. **Daily digest** — You receive a short daily digest of deposits received and orders forwarded — read-only, no action needed.

Feasibility: this is buildable now. A GoCardless bank/payments connector is already available to read incoming payments by date, and scheduled tasks can run the daily reconciliation-and-notify routine. Once your checkout and order reference scheme exist, I can set up the daily task for you.

6. Risks & compliance — read before you advertise

Advertising rules (ASA / CAP)

You are the advertiser, so the advertising liability is yours even though GND fulfils. Every page and ad must state that the value of investments can go down as well as up, that whiskey cask investment is not regulated in the UK, and must avoid guaranteeing returns or implying risk-free / early-retirement outcomes. Keep these disclaimers visible above the fold, not buried.

Non-refundable deposit

Because casks are made to order, the 10% deposit is non-refundable — set this out clearly in the terms and conditions and require an explicit tick-box acknowledgement at checkout, before payment. Have a lawyer confirm the wording works alongside UK consumer-contract rules so the non-refundable term is enforceable.

KYC / AML & data

You collect a passport and full investor details at checkout, before the deposit, which makes you a data controller for that data and potentially in scope for anti-money-laundering checks. Confirm in the GND agreement who owns the KYC obligation, store documents securely, and keep your privacy policy and GDPR basis tight.

Note: *I'm not a lawyer or financial adviser. The points above flag where you need professional advice before launch — they aren't legal or financial advice themselves.*

7. 30-day launch checklist (design & dev)

1. Design the one-page site in the fintech style: hero → why we exist → why whiskey → how it works → calculator → featured cask → GND → trust → FAQ → final CTA.
2. Build the responsive, mobile-first front end with sticky anchor navigation and the two CTAs (Reserve casks / Download guide).

3. Build the interactive cask calculator: crate slider (1-crate minimum, steps of 6 casks), live order value, tiered discount, saving, 10% deposit and estimated future value, updating without page refresh.
4. Build the checkout flow: collect all investor details and passport upload first, assign a unique order reference, add the compliance and non-refundable-deposit tick-boxes, then take the 10% deposit.
5. Integrate the deposit payment method and the KYC verification tool.
6. Build the daily bank-reconciliation task: read the bank connector, match payment references to orders, and auto-send the order pack to GND.
7. Add disclaimers, T&Cs (including the non-refundable deposit) and privacy policy, then QA across devices and ship.

Source — Great Northern Distillery: gndireland.com